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Culture (OWC): [Shona \(FS05\)](#)

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Section Title(S)

3. P.M. (girl) — Form 4, Mufakose • 4. K.C. (boy) — Form 4, Mufakose

If a chicken is cooked, there are special parts of the meat which are not allowed to be eaten by children or the mother, but only the father.

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Among the Shona there is a special day, apart from Sunday, on which no one works. When a girl is sent to someone who is older than her, she must kneel down first and a boy must squat first.

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Whenever someone is sick the first thing they do is to go to an African *n'anga*.

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As far as I know these are the customs I can remember, which my grandmother told me.

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Material Not Relevant

4. K.C. (boy) – Form 4, Mufakose

There are quite a number of Shona customs but, because of the adoption of Western civilisation by the Shona people, most of the customs are being forgotten; as a result I will talk of what I heard and saw of burial, marriage, traditional dances, spiritual and other customs.

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First and foremost I will talk of burial customs. When a person dies the corpse is kept indoors for about three days. This is mainly done so that the relatives of the dead person who live far away may see him for the last time. Relatives, friends and neighbours bring mealie meal and other food so that the mourners may have enough to eat. They spend days and nights mourning. The ritual friends try to console the bereaved, and they do most of the cooking and even make jokes. They appear to be enjoying themselves instead of mourning. These ritual friends play an important role in the washing of the corpse and burying it. If, for example, the dead person is a head of a village community, then a bull or one or more cows have to be slaughtered.

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After the burial the relatives of the dead person find out the cause of the death by consulting a diviner. If the death was caused by man, no action or drastic measures are taken against him.

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Life And Death

Immediately after harvest time the relatives of the dead person brew beer and invite people of all ages, and there will be dancing, *mbira* playing and singing. Then the intimate relatives will carry an earthenware pot full of beer to the grave. They spill some of the beer on the grave. This is done so that the spirit of the dead person will not worry the people. This is then followed by the sweeping of the grave to welcome the spirit to the village.

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Cult Of The Dead

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Prayers And Sacrifices

There are different ways of getting married which I have personally seen, and heard of, namely elopement, pledging and the proper marriage [facing p. 42]

The baby grows up in very close relationship with the mother, who has him strapped to her back most of the time.

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Mode Of Marriage

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Cleanliness Training

Cleanliness is very much stressed right from an early age. Children and babies take a bath every day.



Carrying is an important responsibility.



Children always eat by themselves. By eating from the same plate they learn sharing.



43 recognised in Shona society. During marriage the son-in-law pays *lobola* in the form of money or cattle to the father-in-law and this is charged according to the way of marriage the son-in-law followed. The *lobola* is very high, in most cases due to charges for a suit for the father, dresses for the mother and minor things, like charges for not greeting the father-in-law or the mother-in-law before the engagement.

Human Relations Area Files

755 Prospect Street

New Haven, CT 06511

General Inquiries: ✉ hraf@yale.edu

Issues and Bugs: ✉ hraf-support@yale.edu



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